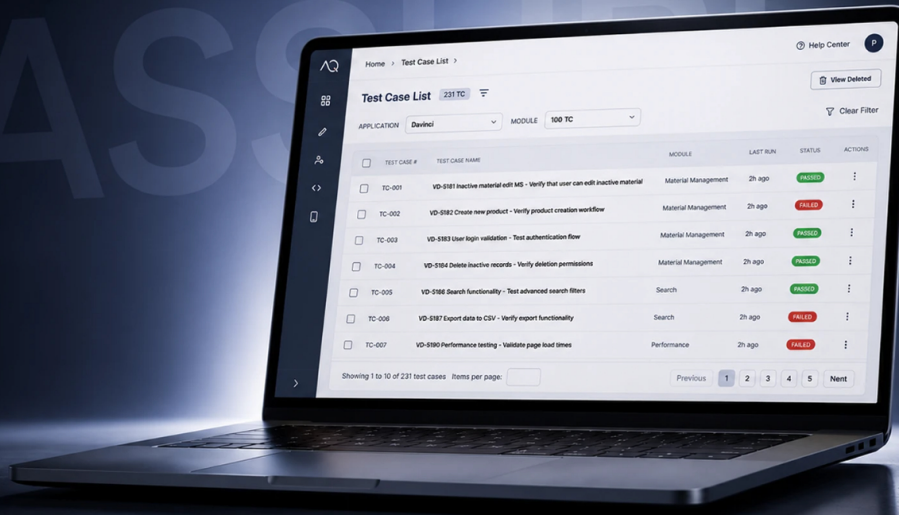


500 test cases. One dropdown. No status. No context. We fixed that.



Redesigning a complex automation testing platform from 0 — transforming a tool QA teams feared into one they actually enjoy using.

ASSURE Q



Role
UI/UX Designer (Solo)

Type
Full Product Redesign

Platform
Web App (B2B / Enterprise)

Source
NoGrunt → AssureQ

Delivered
Test Studio redesign, Test Suites module, Design System, Developer Handoff documentation

01 . PROJECT OVERVIEW

1.1 WHAT IS ASSUREQ ?

AssureQ is an enterprise automation testing platform used by QA teams to manage test cases and execute testing workflows.

Its previous version, NoGrunt, contained all the necessary features but suffered from a confusing user experience that slowed users down. My role was to redesign the platform and make testing simpler, faster, and more intuitive.



User Research

Information Architecture

Interaction Design

Design System

Developer Handoff

High Fidelity UI

1.2 MY ROLE !!

1.3 TIMELINE

8 Weeks

Week - 1							
Discovery							
	Week - 2						
	Research						
		Week - 3					
		Information Architecture					
			Week - 4				
			User Flows				
				Week - 5			
				Wireframes & Exploration			
					Week - 6		
					Visual Design System		
						Week - 7	
						Validation & Iteration	
							Week - 8
							Handoff & Documentation

1.4 CHALLENGE

How might we help QA teams find, organize, and execute test cases faster without overwhelming them with information?

02 . SUCCESS METRICS

Success Criteria

To determine whether the redesign was successful, I defined four measurable goals:



03. RESEARCH & DISCOVERY

Understanding the problem before touching pixels

I started with three types of research of NoGrunt :

stakeholder interviews

user observation sessions

heuristic audit

3.1 USER RESEARCH

Before redesigning screens, I investigated how information architecture and navigation patterns impacted daily QA workflows.

QA

QA Engineer

Primary user · daily usage

Needs to find and run test cases fast.
Spends 3-5 minutes locating a single test case, causing execution delays across daily testing workflows. Hates scrolling through dropdown lists with 500+ items.

QA Engineer

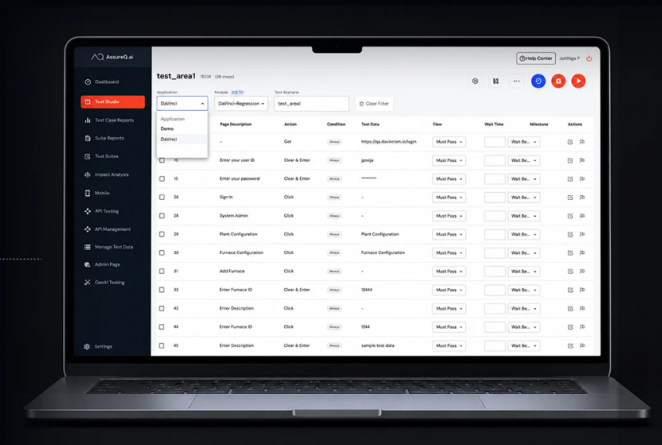
Primary user · daily usage

Needs to find and run test cases fast.
Spends 3-5 minutes locating a single test case, causing execution delays across daily testing workflows. Hates scrolling through dropdown lists with 500+ items.

QA Engineer

Primary user · daily usage

Needs to find and run test cases fast.
Spends 3-5 minutes locating a single test case, causing execution delays across daily testing workflows. Hates scrolling through dropdown lists with 500+ items.



Test Lead

Manager · weekly usage

Needs overview of suite structure and coverage.
Can't see how many test cases are inside suites
without drilling in one by one.

Test Lead

Manager · weekly usage

Needs overview of suite structure and coverage.
Can't see how many test cases are inside suites
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Test Lead

Manager · weekly usage

Needs overview of suite structure and coverage.
Can't see how many test cases are inside suites
without drilling in one by one.



Product Manager

Stakeholder · ad-hoc usage

Needs to review test reports and understand pass/fail status without being a QA expert. Current reports are too technical at a glance.

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PM

User – Prasanthi
Secondary user - daily usage

During observation, we noticed QA engineers would open the module dropdown, scroll halfway, lose their place, and start again. This happened in 3 out of 5 sessions.

User – Prasanthi
Secondary user - daily usage

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User – Prasanthi
Secondary user - daily usage

During observation, we noticed QA engineers would open the module dropdown, scroll halfway, lose their place, and start again. This happened in 3 out of 5 sessions.

“

“ I open the module dropdown, scroll through everything, lose my place, and start again. This happened every single session . . .

“ I open the module dropdown, scroll through everything, lose my place, and start again. This happened every single session . . .

- Observed in 3 out of 5 user sessions, QA Engineer

QA



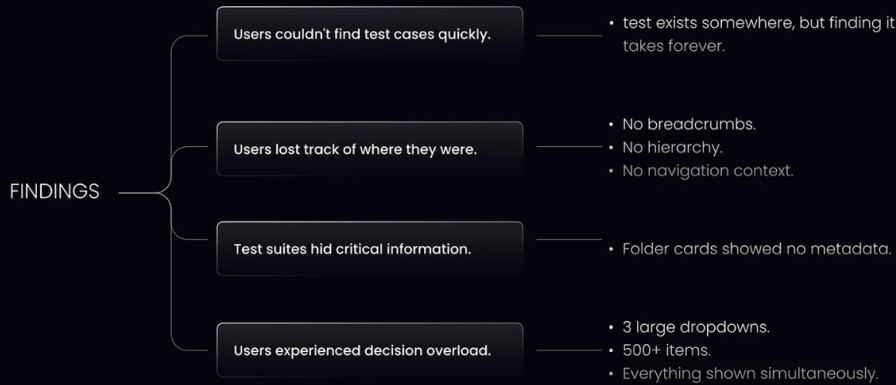
dropdowns on a single screen forcing

500 | test cases visible in a single dropdown

visible test case count in any suite

3.2 RESEARCH FINDINGS

Before redesigning screens, I investigated how information architecture and navigation patterns impacted daily QA workflows.



The heuristic audit surfaced **4** critical violations across both modules:

Visibility of system status

No test count, no last run date, no status on suite cards

Match between system and mental model

Dropdown-first navigation doesn't match how QA teams think about test hierarchies

Recognition over recall

Users had to remember module names and locations with no visible cues

Aesthetic and minimalist design

Every screen showed all possible actions simultaneously

04 . PROJECT CONSTRAINTS

stakeholder interviews

user observation sessions

heuristic audit

Technical Constraints

- Existing backend architecture could not be modified.
- Existing test case relationships had to remain intact.
- Navigation improvements had to work with current data structures.

Business Constraints

- Redesign had to avoid disrupting active QA workflows.
- Solution needed to support both experienced and new QA users.
- Scope was limited to navigation and discoverability improvements.

Design Constraint

- Improve usability without increasing interface complexity.

05 . AFFINITY MAP

Turning research observations into actionable design insights

Navigation Friction

Discoverability

Hidden Hierarchy

Cognitive Overload

Workflow Efficiency

Lost location

Large dropdowns

Flat folder cards

Too many choices

Repetitive actions

No breadcrumbs

No search visibility

No nested visibility

Simultaneous

Extra clicks

No breadcrumbs	No context history	No nested history	decisions	Enter errors
Memory reliance	Hidden metadata	No counts visible	Context switching	Scattered actions
Inconsistent paths	Hard to find TCs	Poor structure	Information overload	Slower execution

“

Patterns from the affinity map directly shaped which journey stages we mapped in depth.

”

06 . JOURNEY MAPPING

Understanding the Existing Test Execution Workflow

To identify where users experienced friction, I mapped the journey of a QA Engineer while locating and executing a test case in NoGrunt.

Stage	User Action	Experience	Cognitive Overload	Opportunity
Enter Test Studio	Open testing module	Clear starting point	None	Maintain simplicity
Select Application	Choose application from dropdown	Easy	None	Keep existing pattern
Select Module	Browse module list	Manageable	Long lists in some cases	Better organization
Find Test Case	Search through 500+ test cases in	Frustrating	Poor discoverability,	Dedicated test case

Find Test Case	Test Case in dropdown	Maximizing	information overload	explorer
Verify Selection	Check if selected test case is correct	Uncertain	No preview or metadata	Show context before selection
Execute Test Case	Open and start execution	Functional	Too many steps before reaching here	Streamline workflow
Repeat Process	Navigate back and repeat	Time consuming	Repetitive navigation	Faster access to related test cases

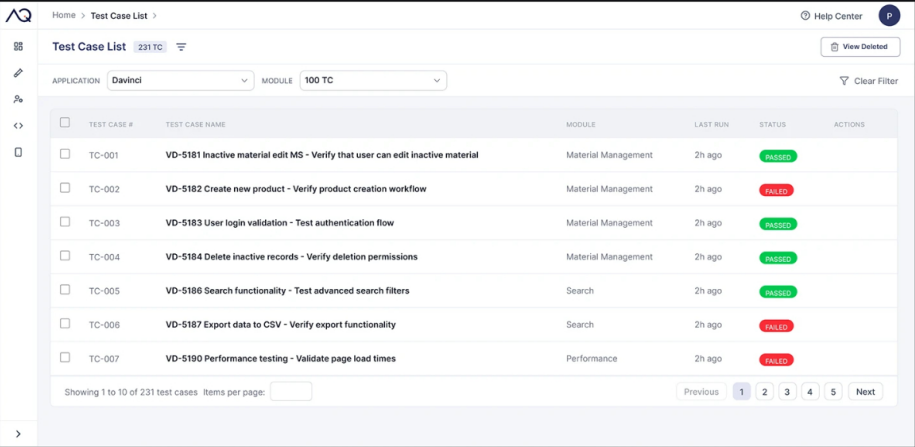
07 . USER FLOW

Mapping the journeys that mattered most

I identified three critical user flows that accounted for 80% of daily usage. Each was redesigned around progressive disclosure – commit to context one step at a time.

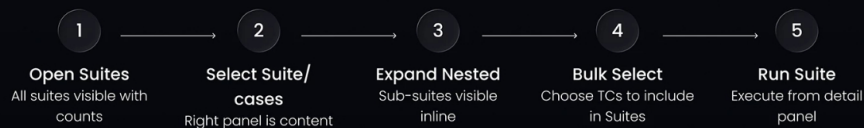
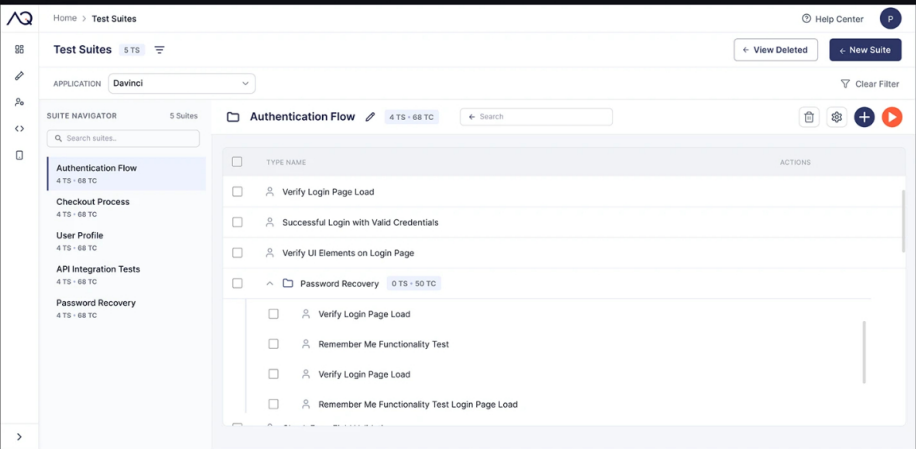
User Flow A – (Test Execution)

Help QA teams locate and execute a test case with minimal navigation effort.



User Flow B – (Test Suite Navigation)

Make suite hierarchy visible while reducing unnecessary exploration.



08. INSIGHTS → DESIGN STRATEGY

How Research Shaped The Solution

RESEARCH FINDING		DESIGN RESPONSE
Users lost location	→	Breadcrumbs
Hidden hierarchy	→	Two-panel navigator
Large dropdowns	→	Dedicated TC explorer
Decision overload	→	Progressive workflow
Hidden metadata	→	Context-rich lists

5.1 Mapping the system before redesigning it

Before any wireframes, I mapped the complete IA of NoGrunt – every screen, every entity relationship, every nav path. This revealed structural problems I couldn't have found from screenshots alone.



Global elements – present on all screens



5.2 Key Insight

- The problem wasn't missing features – NoGrunt had everything QA teams needed.
- The problem was that features were organized around system logic, not user workflows.
- Users had to learn the system's structure to do their job. The redesign flipped this: structure now follows how QA engineers actually think and work.

10. KEY DESIGN DECISIONS

A deeper look into the architectural and user experience choices made during the product development process.

Decision 01

Move TC selection to dedicated screen.

PROBLEM

500+ TCs inside dropdown.

REASON

Provides visibility, pagination, filtering, status, and execution context.

ALTERNATIVES EXPLORED

OPTION A

Searchable Dropdown

✗ Still overwhelming

OPTION A

Grouped Dropdown

✗ Doesn't scale

OPTION A

Dedicated Screen

✓ Chosen

Home > Test Case List >

Test Case List 231 TC View Deleted

APPLICATION Davinci MODULE 100 TC Clear Filter

TEST CASE #	TEST CASE NAME	MODULE	LAST RUN	STATUS	ACTIONS
TC-001	VD-5181 Inactive material edit M5 - Verify that user can edit inactive material	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	
TC-002	VD-5182 Create new product - Verify product creation workflow	Material Management	2h ago	FAILED	
TC-003	VD-5183 User login validation - Test authentication flow	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	

Screen 1

Home > Test Case List > Test Steps

VD-5181 Inactive material... 36 steps

APPLICATION Davinci MODULE 100TC TEST CASE VD-5181 Inactive ... Clear Filter

STEP #	PAGE DESCRIPTION	ACTION	TEST DATA	FLOW	WAIT TIME	MILESTONE	ACTIONS
0	-	Get	https://qa.davincsim.io/login	Must Pass	Wait ...	-	
2	Enter your user ID	Clear & Enter	Test (14869)	Must Pass	Wait ...	-	
12	Enter your password	Clear & Enter		Must Pass	Wait ...	-	

Screen 2

Decision 02

Two Panel Suite Navigator

PROBLEM

Users couldn't understand suite hierarchy.

ALTERNATIVES EXPLORED

OPTION A

Folder Cards

✗ Hidden structure

REASON

REASON

Matches mental model of file explorer.

OPTION A

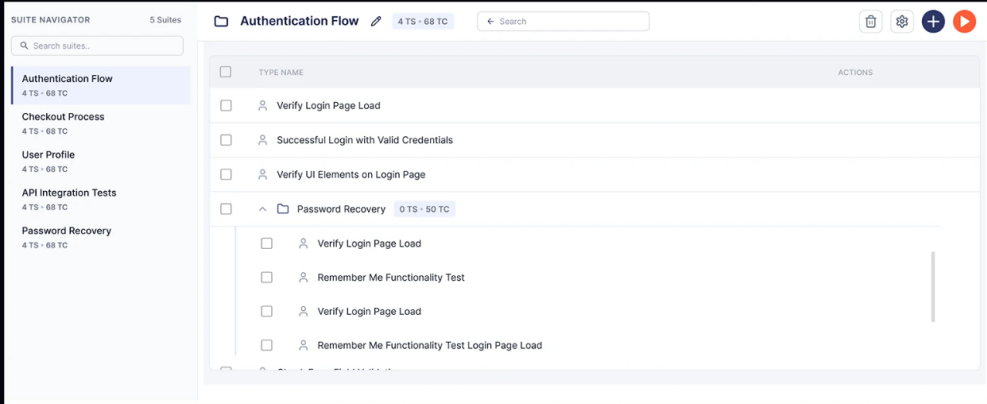
Tree Table

✕ Complex

OPTION A

Two Panel Layout

✓ Chosen



Decision 03

Status Pills over Text Labels

PROBLEM

Test case health was invisible. Users couldn't scan pass/fail without opening each case.

REASON

Instant visual scanning. Color + label = accessible and fast. QA engineers can review 20 cases in seconds.

ALTERNATIVES EXPLORED

OPTION A

Text labels (Pass/Fail/Running)

✕ Slow to scan

OPTION A

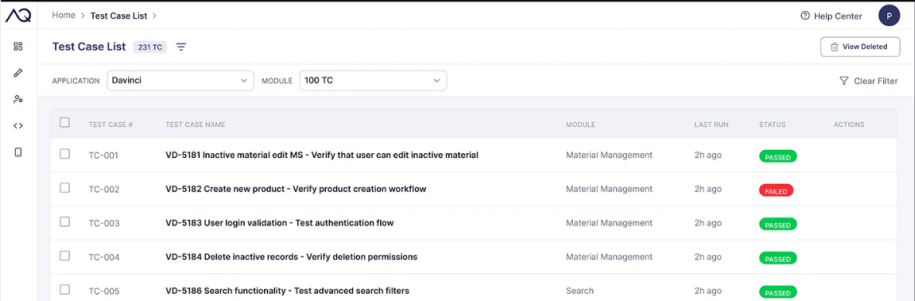
Color-coded rows

✕ Accessibility issues

OPTION A

Status Pills

✓ Chosen



☐	TC-006	VD-5187 Export data to CSV - Verify export functionality	Search	2h ago	FAILED
☐	TC-007	VD-5190 Performance testing - Validate page load times	Performance	2h ago	FAILED

Showing 1 to 10 of 231 test cases. Items per page:

Previous [1](#) [2](#) [3](#) [4](#) [5](#) Next

11. WHY NOT OTHER SOLUTIONS?

Solution 01

Why We Didn't Use Global Search

REASON

Although search would improve discoverability, it would not solve the underlying hierarchy problem. Users still needed to understand relationships between suites, modules, and test cases.

Solution 02

Why We Didn't Keep Dropdown Navigation

REASON

Even with search and grouping, dropdowns continued to hide context and scale poorly as datasets grew.

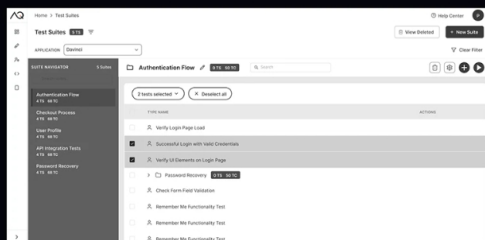
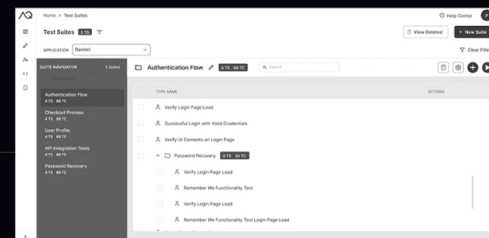
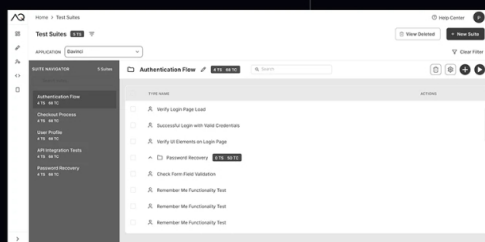
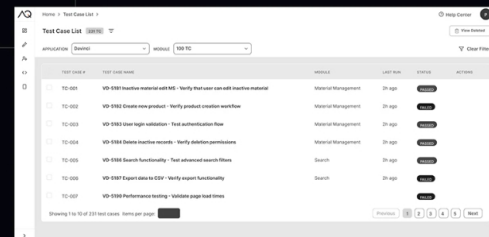
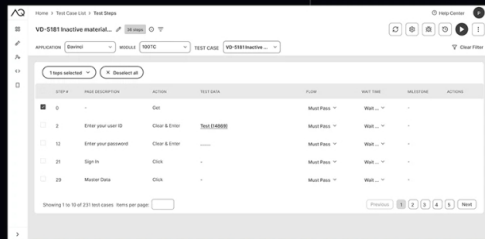
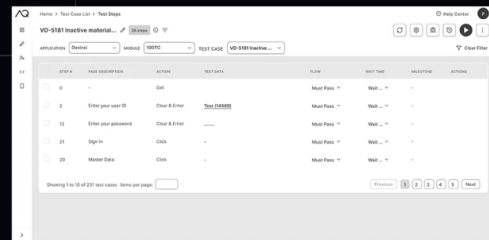
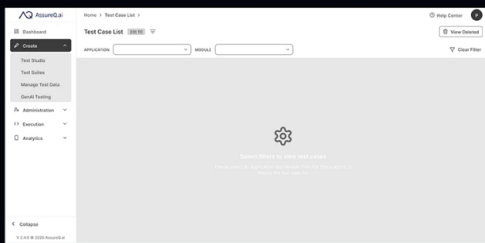
Solution 03

Why Dedicated Views Won

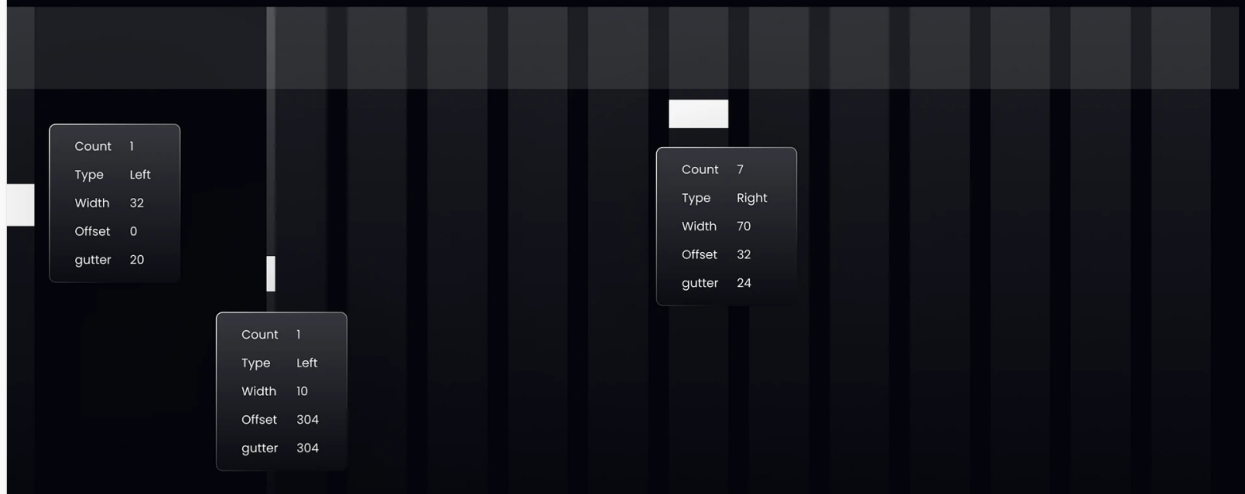
REASON

Dedicated views provided visibility, metadata, filtering, and progressive navigation while remaining scalable.

12. WIREFRAMES



13.1 GRIDS



13.2 FONT

Inter Fon

Aa Bb Cc Dd Ee Ff Gg Hh Ii Jj
Kk Ll Mm Nn Oo Pp Qq Rr Ss Tt
Uu Vv Ww Xx Yy Zz

Inter is a variable font family carefully crafted & designed for computer screens.

Inter features in the readability of mixed-case and lower-case text. Several OpenType features are provided as well, like contextual alternates that adjust punctuation depending on the shape of surrounding glyphs, slashed zero for when you need to disambiguate "0" from "o", tabular numbers, etc.

Regular

Medium

Bold

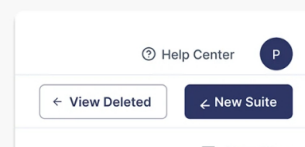
Aa

13.3 COLOR PALETTE

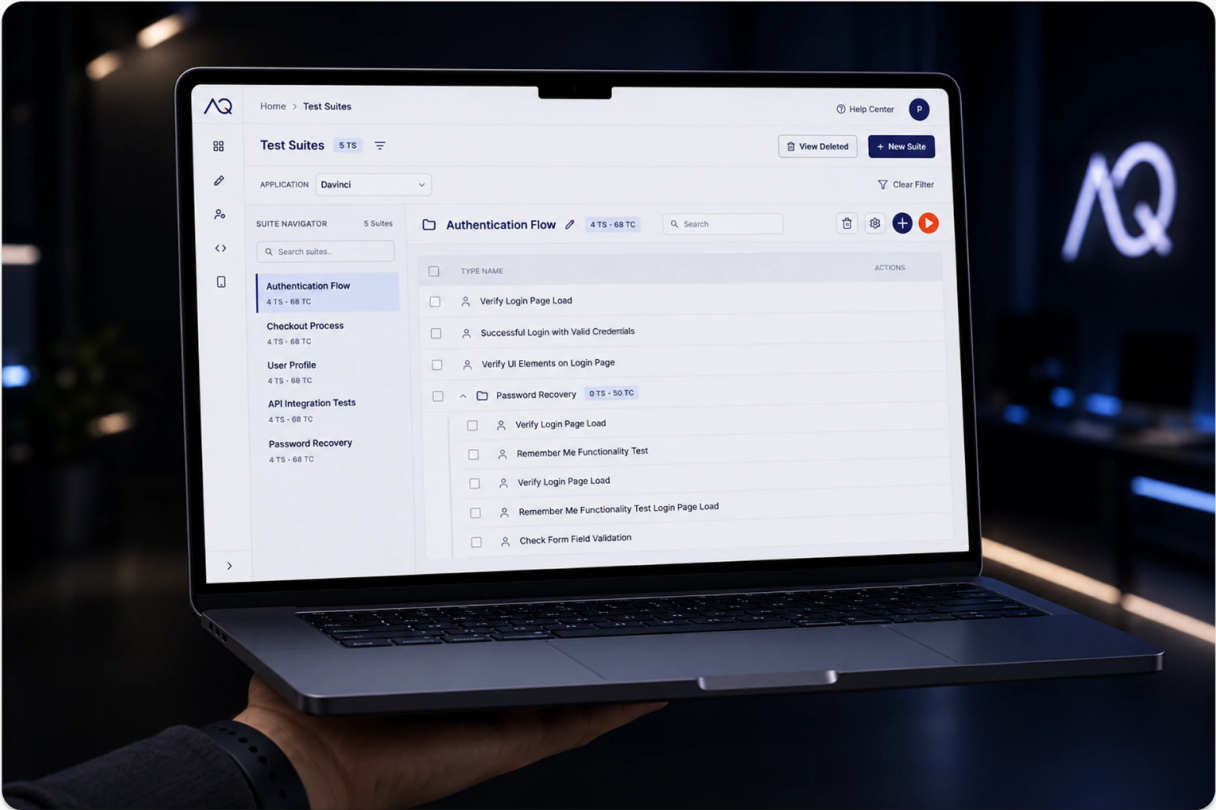
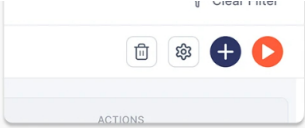


The problem with the old colours NoGrunt used dark orange and dark blue heavily across the entire interface. The screens felt visually heavy.

What we changed We shifted to a white-dominant theme with blue and orange used intentionally.



F4F6F9

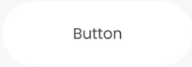


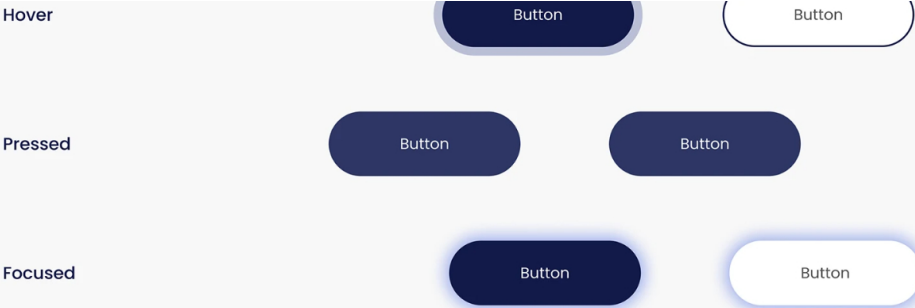
13.4 LOGO



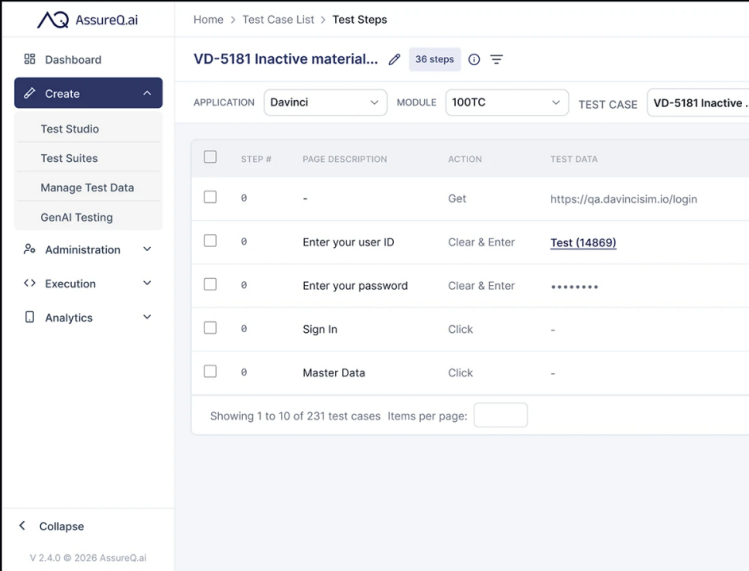
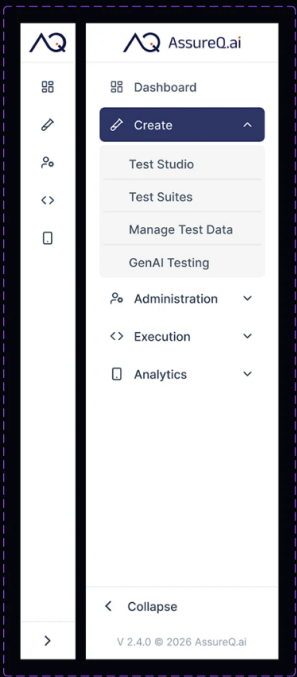
13.5 BUTTONS

Default



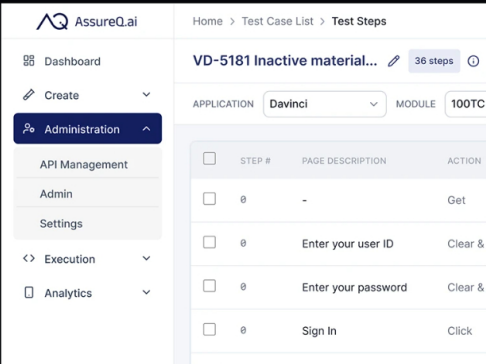
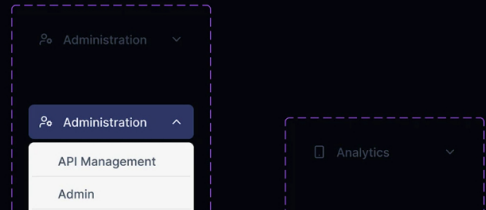


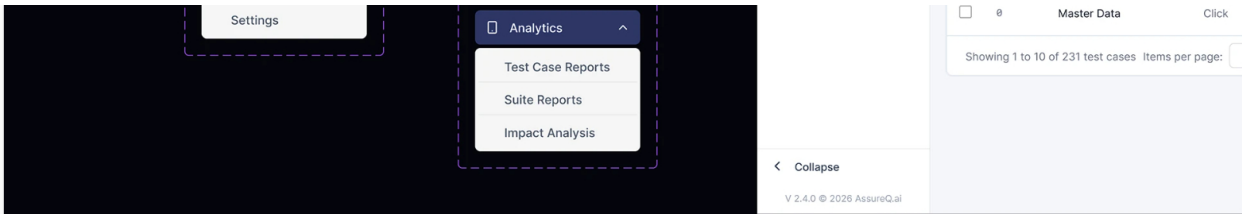
13.6 COMPONENTS



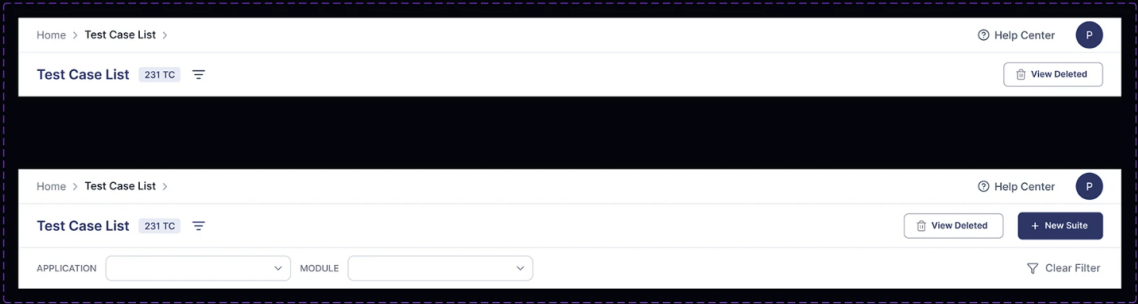
Side Navigation Menu : Designed to reduce navigation friction by organizing all modules within a single, scalable navigation system.

Expandable Navigation Groups : Progressive disclosure keeps navigation clean while making related modules easy to discover.



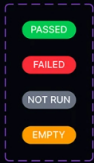


Collapsble Filter Bar : Balances discoverability and workspace efficiency by letting users hide secondary controls.



TEST CASE #	TEST CASE NAME	MODULE	LAST RUN	STATUS	ACTIONS
TC-001	VD-5181 Inactive material edit MS - Verify that user can edit inactive material	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	
TC-002	VD-5182 Create new product - Verify product creation workflow	Material Management	2h ago	FAILED	
TC-003	VD-5183 User login validation - Test authentication flow	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	

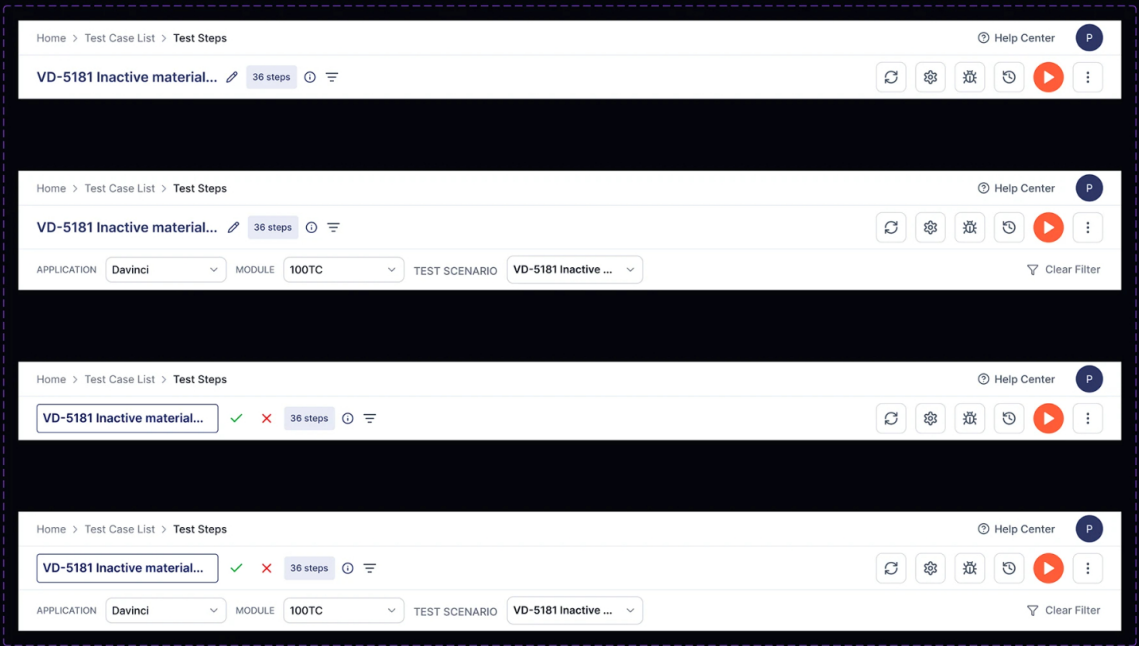
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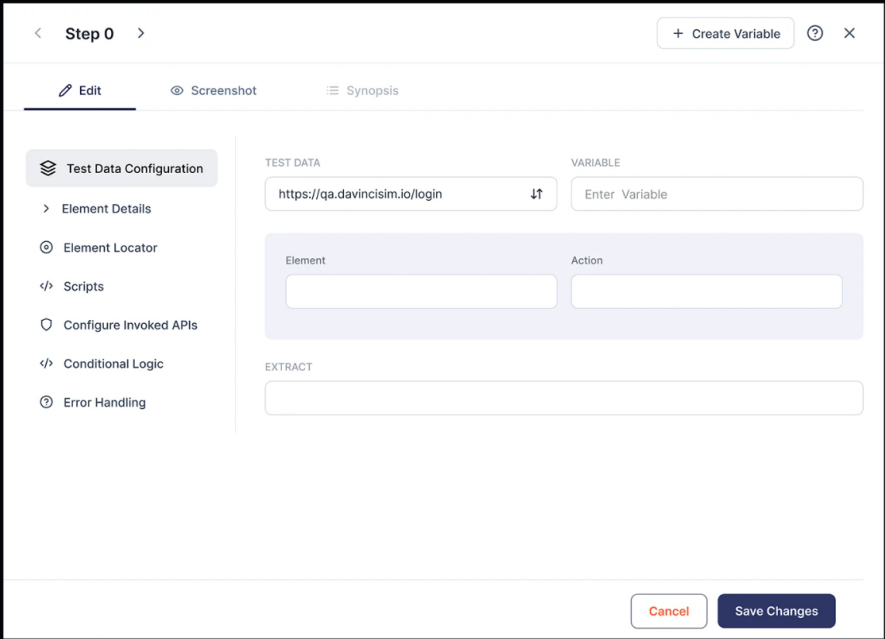
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TC-003	VD-5183 User login validation - Test authentication flow	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	
TC-004	VD-5184 User login validation - Test authentication flow	Material Management	2h ago	PASSED	
TC-005	VD-5185 User login validation - Test authentication flow	Search	2h ago	PASSED	

Status Pills : Provides immediate visual feedback on test health, improving monitoring and decision-making speed.

Rename : Inline editing pattern that supports faster and more efficient content management.



Tab Structure : Organizes complex settings into focused sections, making advanced configurations easier to navigate and manage.



Create Suite

← Button →

← Button →

Modal / Pop-up : Supports task completion within context without forcing users to leave their current workflow.

Create Suite

SUITE NAME

Enter Suite Name...

Cancel Save

Move to Test Suite

APPLICATION TEST SUITE

Cancel Save

Pagination : Improves navigation through large datasets by breaking content into manageable sections.

Showing 1 to 10 of 231 test cases Items per page: Previous 1 2 3 4 5 Next

Context Menu : Offers frequently used actions directly at the point of interaction, reducing navigation effort.

Wait time (seconds)

Enter seconds

Wait Before

Wait After

Wait Till Found

Wait For All API

Wait For Configured APIs

Check

✗ ✓

+ Create Test Case

⊙ Set Flow Status

⌘ Set Conditional Logic

⌚ Edit Wait Time

✎ Bulk Edit Keyword & Action

⌘ Remove Conditional Logic

📄 Inline Test Steps

🗑 Delete Test Steps

📄 Convert Steps to Assertions

↕ Swap Steps

👁 View Hidden & Deleted Steps

A scalable configuration framework that combines tab navigation and reusable components to support complex QA workflows while maintaining clarity and usability.

Settings

Run Parameters Integration Variables Scheduler

Run Settings

🔴 Terminate test even if a Re-run failed test cases 🟡 Runs Tests in Parallel 🟢 Re Run Tests In Parallel 🔴 Synchronized Tests

single test case fails

☐ Benchmark Tests

☐ Headless Execution

☐ Capture screenshots only on test failure

☒ Email individual test result

☐ Enable Video Recording

Environment

As Recorded ✓

1.0.10

qa

Screen Resolution

1920 × 1080

1440 × 780

1366 × 768

1280 × 780

Browser

Firefox

Chrome

Safari

Edge

All

Threshold

Proxy URL

Profile Name

0

Enter proxy URL

Enter proxy URL

Test Case Processing

This feature applies only within a test suite execution context. It allows automatic pre/post test case execution to reset configurations or environment state when a test fails, ensuring that dependent test cases in the same suite do not fail due to residual side effects.

Execution Condition

☒ If Pass

☐ If Fail

☐ Always

Select Test Case

Application

Module

Test Scenario

Search Test Cases

Test Scenario Settings

Environment

As Recorded ✓

1.0.10

qa

Description

Enter description...

☒ Run Once

☐ Run In Stealth Mode

☐ Auto Solve Captcha

☒ Continue Previous Scenario

☐ Enable Audio/Video

☐ Run In New Session

☐ Keep Browser Open on Test Step Failure

14. INTERACTION PRINCIPLES

The **3 principles** that guided every design decision:

1. PROGRESSIVE DISCLOSURE

Show users one decision at a time. App → Module → Test Case → Steps. Each screen has exactly one job.

2. VISIBLE HIERARCHY

If a user can't see the structure without clicking, the structure is broken. Every count, every nesting level, every status is surfaced by default.

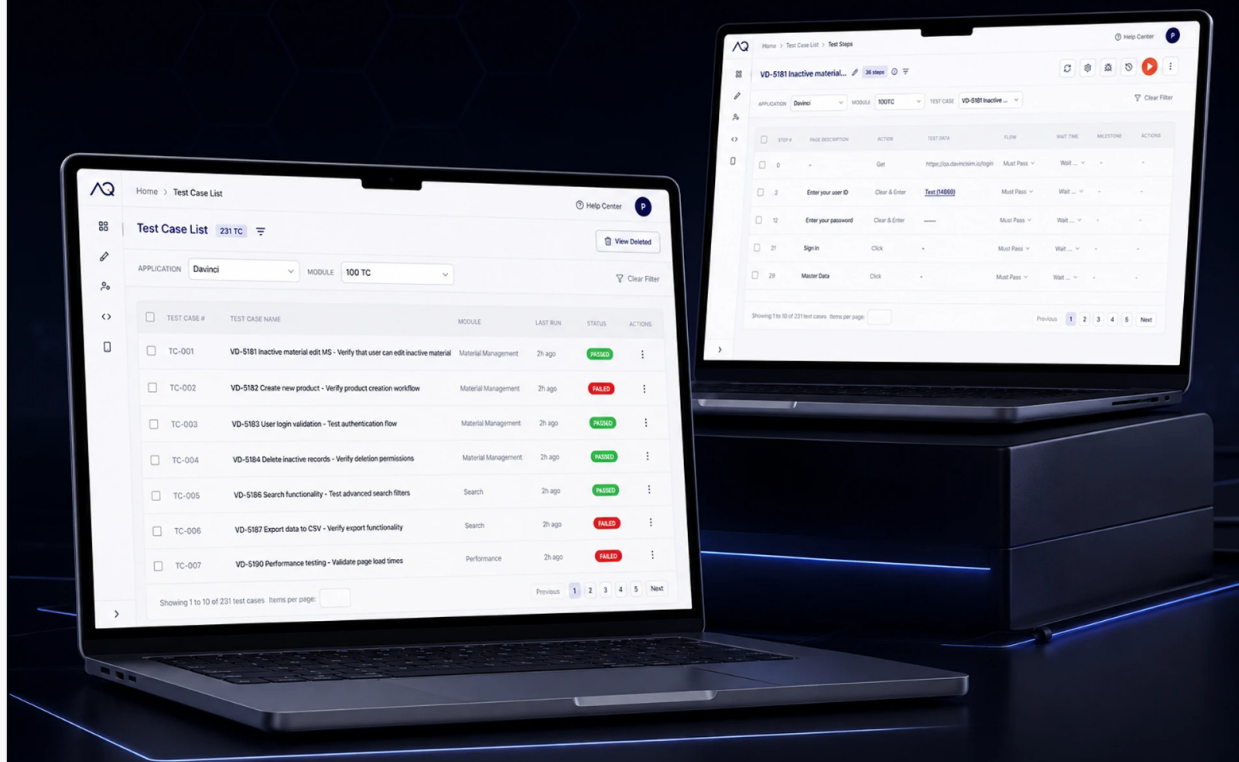
3. CONTEXT-SCOPED ACTIONS

Actions available at each screen level match only what's relevant at that moment. No global action menus. No decision overload.

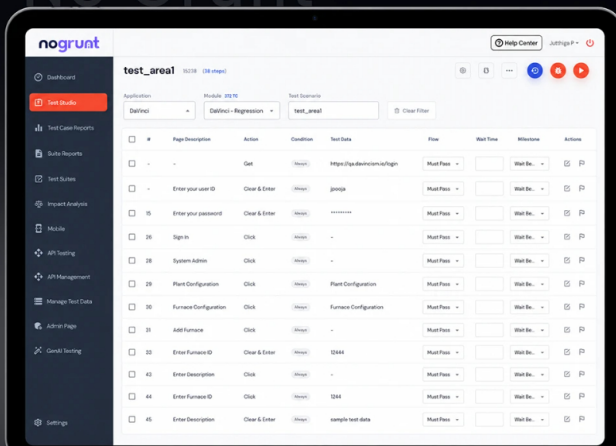
15. FINAL INTERFACES VISUALS

Module – 1 : Test Studio

The NoGrunt Test Studio crammed **Application, Module, and Test Scenario** selection into a single screen above a flat list of steps.



No Grunt



What was broken

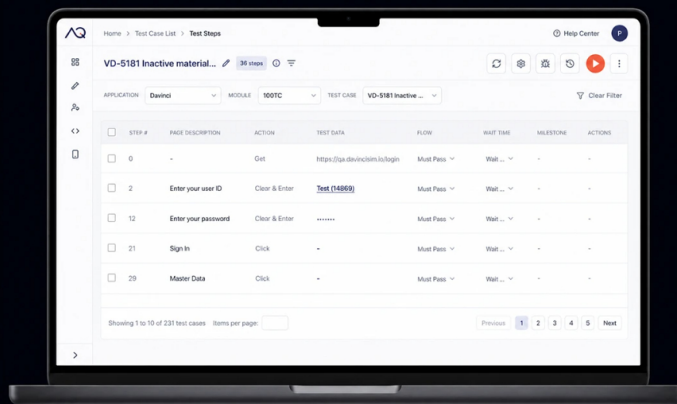
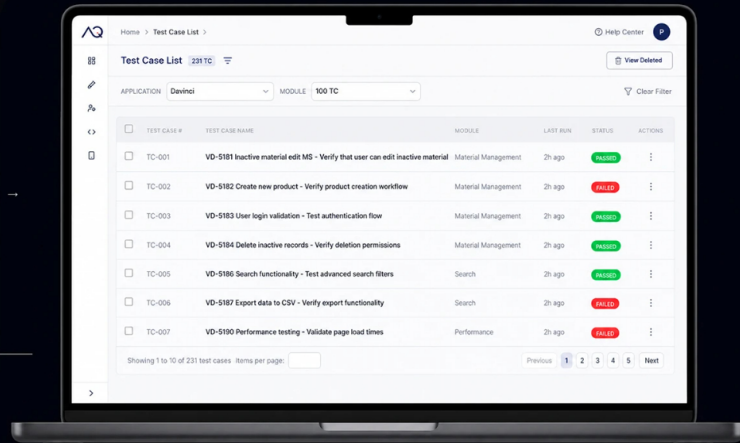
- 3 dropdowns on one screen, no hierarchy
- 500 TCs in a single unfiltered dropdown
- No TC count, no status, no last run info
- All nav actions at every level simultaneously
- No empty state – blank screen with no filter
- Persistent dropdowns waste screen space

A module with 500+ test cases meant scrolling through 500 items in a dropdown with no status, no last run, no context at all.

AssureQ

What changed - Test Case list Screen

- Progressive flow: App → Module → Test case List → Test Steps List
- Dedicated TC List screen with pagination
- Context-scoped actions per screen level

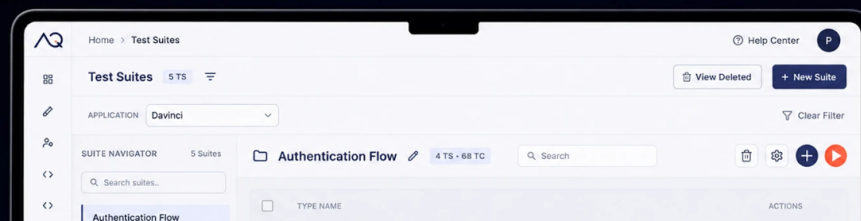


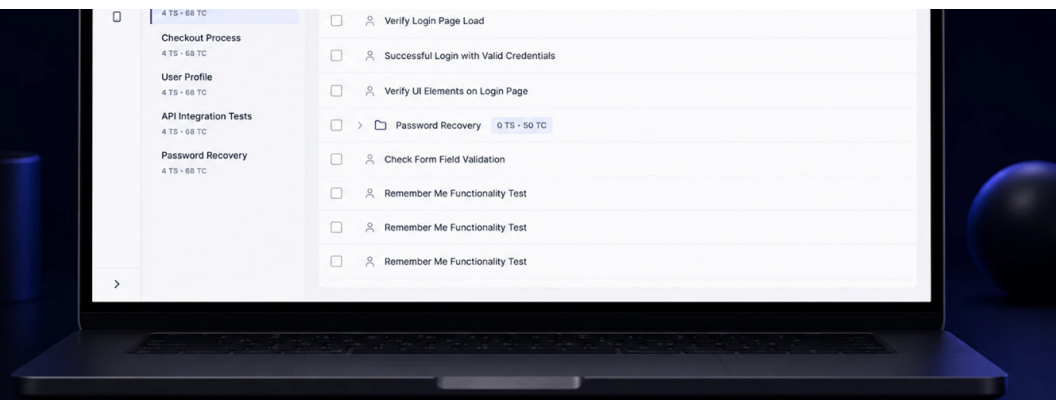
What changed - Test Step list Screen

- Can choose individual Test Case
- Everything Test step is shown in this level with classified actions Menu

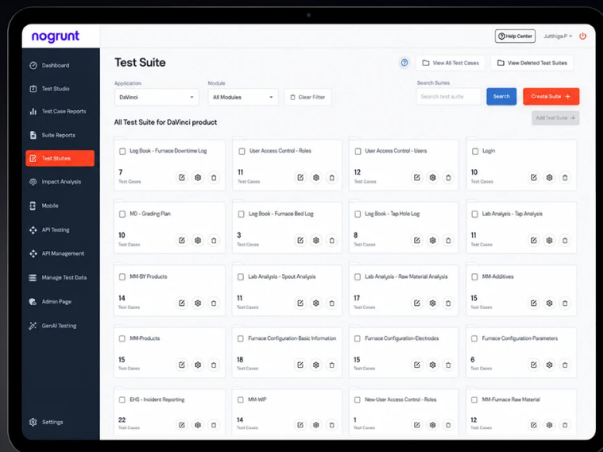
Module - 2 : Test Suites

Making hierarchy visible at last . test suites were flat folder icon cards. You had no idea how many test cases were inside, or whether nested suites existed.





No Grunt



Making hierarchy visible at last

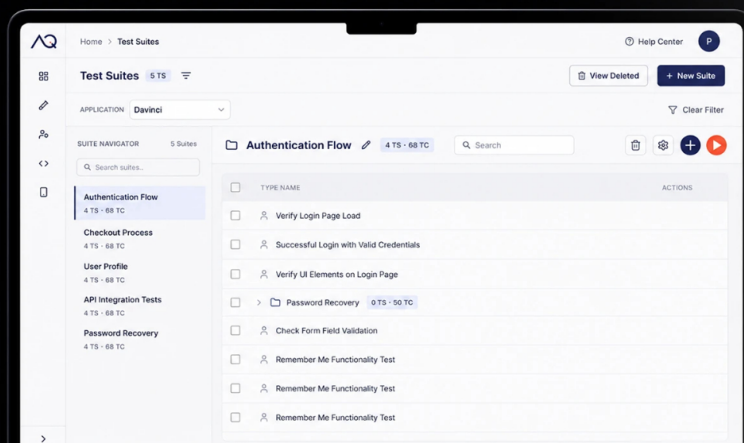
- In NoGrunt, test suites appeared as simple folder cards,
- giving no visibility into the number of test cases, nested suites, or overall structure.
- Users had to open each suite individually, making test planning slow and inefficient.

AssureQ

What changed - Test Case list Screen

Redesign:

- Two-Panel Test Suite Navigator
- Scrollable suite tree for quick navigation
- Live detail panel for immediate context
- Reduced unnecessary clicks during test planning



16. VALIDATION

Testing whether the redesign actually solved the problem

Before finalizing the redesign, I conducted internal usability validation sessions with QA stakeholders to evaluate whether the new workflow reduced navigation effort and improved task completion.

16.1 TASK GIVEN

Locate and execute a specific test case (TC-031) within the platform.

16.2 RESULT

Before (NoGrunt)	After (AssureQ)
Time To Locate & Execute TC-031 4m 12s	Time To Locate & Execute TC-031 58s
Navigation Steps Multiple dropdown selections	Navigation Steps Progressive workflow
Hierarchy Visibility Hidden	Hierarchy Visibility Visible
User Confidence Low	User Confidence High

16.3 KEY OBSERVATIONS

- Users spent significantly less time searching for test cases.
- Hierarchical relationships were immediately understandable.
- Reduced confusion during navigation and task execution.
- Participants completed tasks with greater confidence and fewer errors.
- The dedicated Test Case List improved discoverability and workflow clarity.

16.4 VALIDATION INSIGHT

The redesign confirmed that the primary challenge was not test execution itself, but the effort required to locate and navigate to the correct test case.

17. BEFORE VS AFTER



NoGrunt overall

- Single-screen overload — everything at once
- Dropdown scrolling for 100–400 test cases
- Folder icon cards with zero metadata
- No visible hierarchy in suites
- No breadcrumb — users lost their place

AssureQ overall

- Progressive disclosure — one decision per screen
- Paginated TC list with status and last run
- Two-panel suite navigator with full counts
- Inline nested suite expansion
- Breadcrumb trail throughout all modules



18. IMPACT

18.1 Results that validated every decision

The redesign focused on improving discoverability, hierarchy visibility, and workflow efficiency across the platform.

Metric	Before	After
Time to Locate TC-031	4m 12s	58s
Hierarchy Visibility	Hidden	Visible

Workflow Structure

Multiple Dropdowns

Guided Navigation

User Confidence

Low

High

18.1 Feedbacks

What Users Reported ?

“

Finding the right test case became significantly easier.

”

- QA Engineer

“

The suite hierarchy finally made sense.

”

- Test Lead

“

The workflow felt more predictable and structured.

”

- Product Manager

18.3 Key Outcomes

Reduced navigation complexity across modules

Improved discoverability of test cases

Increased visibility of hierarchy relationships

Reduced dependence on memory-based navigation

Created a scalable IA foundation for future growth

18.4 Validation Method

Outcomes were derived from stakeholder interviews, internal usability validation sessions, workflow observation, and comparative task-completion testing conducted before and after the redesign.

19 . REFLECTION

19.1 What This Project Reinforced

Enterprise complexity rarely lives in the data — it lives in how the data is organized and surfaced.

NoGrunt had every feature QA teams needed. The problem was that the system was built around database logic, not human workflows. Users had to learn the system before they could do their job.

Progressive disclosure isn't just a UX pattern — it's a trust-building tool. Every time a user sees exactly what they need and nothing they don't, the product feels like it understands them.

19.2 What I'd Explore Next

- AI-powered test case search: surface relevant TCs based on module context and recent runs
- Cross-module shortcuts for repeated workflows (e.g. quick-run from dashboard)
- Long-term adoption tracking to measure workflow efficiency at scale
- Expand usability testing to QA teams across different organization types and sizes

19.3 Final Takeaway

Great product experiences are not created by adding more functionality—they are created by helping users reach their goals with less effort and greater confidence.

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they are created by helping users reach their goals with less effort and greater confidence.



AssureQ | Redesigning Test Discovery & Navigation

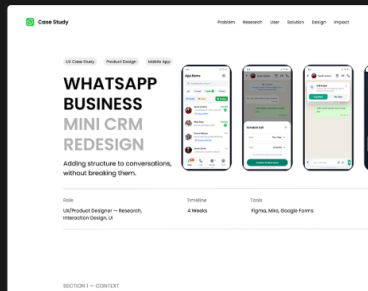
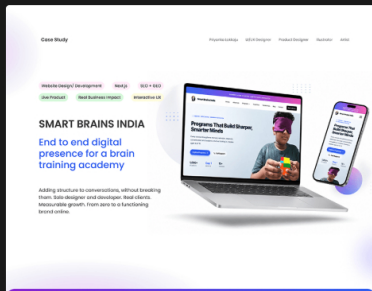
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Lakkoju Priyanka

Edit Project



What are your thoughts on this project?

Post a Comment

OWNER



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AssureQ is an enterprise test management platform designed for QA teams managing large-scale testing operations. This case study explores how res

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TOOLS

Figma , Figjam

CREATIVE FIELDS





- UI UX design
- product design
- UX Case Study
- Enterprise Software
- SaaS Design
- user experience
- dashboard design
- UI/UX
- design system
- Case Study